

Twin Menace

'Evil twins' are the latest menace to the security of WiFi Internet users, warn experts in the UK. An 'evil twin' is a bogus base station. Victims may transmit valuable personal information, not suspecting that these are being intercepted by cybercriminals.



Pentop Computing

LeapFrog Enterprises' new FLY 'pentop computer' is a talking pen that can translate words and help with maths and spelling. A user can draw a calculator, touch the handwritten digits to perform an operation, and hear the answers announced.



Enter

Amar Singh Politician

High-flying Rajya Sabha MP Amar Singh is known for his close association with the who's who of corporate India and Bollywood. Technology, though, is not one of his strengths. He admits he is still adapting to technology, and is candid enough to admit his overall tech ignorance.

What does technology mean to you?

Technology amazes me since I grew up in harder times. Today, when I see a paperless office or a tiny chip storing huge chunks of data, I realise the power of technology.

What gadgets do you use?

My Nokia cell phone is indispensable. My office handles most of my correspondence on e-mail. I also have a home theatre system.

How tech savvy are politicians?

Most politicians cannot take decisions on technology.

Do you surf the Net?

Yes. There are Web sites in my name and I like to check those. We also have a basic party website.

Is e-Governance possible for Uttar Pradesh (UP)?

I believe it is. I met Infosys CEO Nandan Nilekani, who plans to frame an IT policy for UP. We are trying to computerise land records and build Internet kiosks, and Nandan has promised to turn UP into the new Silicon Valley.

GET .IN

'in' Domain Names Up For Grabs

The Government of India recently inaugurated the registration process for '.in' domain names. A special 'Sunrise' period, from January 1, 2005, was allotted to trademark holders to register their .in domain names.

Corporates as well as individuals holding registered trademarks could register their .in domain name till January 21. Post January 21, registration was thrown open to the public.

Applicants who did not register their domain names ran the risk of losing their domains to cybersquatters. At present, there are five lakh trade names registered in India.

INRegistry (www.registry.in/), the official .in registry, appointed by the Government of India, operates under the aegis of the National Internet eXchange of India (NIXI).

NIXI is a not-for-profit organisation that seeks to facilitate improved Internet services in the country. INRegistry functions as an autonomous body within the NIXI fold to maintain the .in ccTLD (country code top-level domain, which is used and reserved for a

country or a dependent territory) and ensure its operational stability, reliability and security. INRegistry will also implement new initiatives undertaken by the Ministry of Communications and



Illustrations Harsho Mohan chottoraj

Information Technology that falls under the aegis of the Department of Information Technology.

Accredited registrars such as Net4India (www.net4india.co.in/), OnlineNIC (www.onlinenic.com/), DirectI (www.directi.com/) and Good Luck Domains (www.goodluckdomain.com/) will facilitate the registration process.

Says Jasjit Sawhney, CEO, Net4India, "The 'Sunrise' period has been designed to avoid problems of trademark infringement and cybersquatting. There is also a Dispute Resolution

Policy using which, companies can attempt to claim their name back if they feel someone is using one that they have a right to."

Most of the top corporate organisations in India have registered their main brand and/or company names already for the trademarks they hold. "Net4India alone would be registering more than 10,000 names/extensions by February 16. This is more than the total ever registered in the seven to eight years that the manual process has been in place," says Sawhney.

SECURE YOUR WINDOWS

More Security Updates For Windows

Microsoft Corp is warning users that they need three security updates, including one that applies even to computers that have downloaded the company's massive fix for Windows XP. Two of the flaws which carry the company's most severe threat rating affect versions of its dominant OS going back to Windows 98.

One even affects users who have downloaded